

THE SPLUNK

THE SPLUNK HOME LAB Personal Practice

On my project, I used Splunk as our central observability hub. I configured forwarders to stream logs from our web servers and databases into a centralized index. I then created alerts that triggered whenever HTTP 500 error rates spiked above a 5% threshold. This allowed our operations team to proactively catch system crashes before users started reporting them. It also helps Security teams by detecting cyberattacks. By analyzing network traffic, login attempts, and firewall logs all at once, Splunk can raise an alarm if an unauthorized user is trying to breach the system.

TASK 1

1. ADMINISTRATOR CREDENTIALS SETUP.

The screenshot shows the Splunk 'Set Source Type' configuration page. The breadcrumb trail is 'Add Data > Set Source Type'. The progress bar indicates the current step is 'Set Source Type'. The source is 'huawei_firewall_01.txt'. The 'Source type' is set to 'huawei:firewall'. A 'Save As' button is visible. The main table displays a list of events, with the first event selected. The table has columns for 'Time' and 'Event'.

	Time	Event
1	6/10/26 8:00:00.000 AM	June 10 08:00:00 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1001]: Login failed. (UserName=admin, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)
2	6/10/26 8:00:07.000 AM	June 10 08:00:07 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1002]: Login failed. (UserName=admin, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)
3	6/10/26 8:00:14.000 AM	June 10 08:00:14 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1003]: Login failed. (UserName=admin, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)
4	6/10/26 8:00:21.000 AM	June 10 08:00:21 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1004]: Login failed. (UserName=netadmin, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)
5	6/10/26 8:00:28.000 AM	June 10 08:00:28 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1005]: Login failed. (UserName=backup, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)
6	6/10/26 8:00:45.000 AM	June 10 08:00:45 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1006]: Login failed. (UserName=root, IPAddress=185.73.44.21, VTY=0, Protocol=SSH)

Login | Networking Academy with Cl... (3) Inbox | cliff0rd@proton.me | Proto... Add Data - Input Settings | Splunk x +

localhost:8000/en-US/manager/splunk_secure_gateway/adddatamethods/inputsettings#

splunk>enterprise Apps Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Add Data

Select Source Set Source Type Input Settings Review Done < Back Review >

Host

When the Splunk platform indexes data, each event receives a "host" value. The host value should be the name of the machine from which the event originates. The type of input you choose determines the available configuration options. [Learn More](#)

Host field value:

Index

The Splunk platform stores incoming data as events in the selected index. Consider using a "sandbox" index as a destination if you have problems determining a source type for your data. A sandbox index lets you troubleshoot your configuration without impacting production indexes. You can always change this setting later. [Learn More](#)

Index: [Create a new index](#)

FAQ

- > How do indexes work?
- > How do I know when to create or use multiple indexes?

9:38 AM 9/10/2026

Login | Networking Academy with Cl... (3) Inbox | cliff0rd@proton.me | Proto... Add Data - Review | Splunk 10.4 x +

localhost:8000/en-US/manager/splunk_secure_gateway/adddatamethods/review

splunk>enterprise Apps Administrator Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Add Data

Select Source Set Source Type Input Settings Review Done < Back Submit >

Review

Input Type Uploaded File
File Name huawei_firewall_01.txt
Source Type huawei:firewall
Host DESKTOP-4FDES0I
Index firewall01_log

9:57 AM 9/10/2026

I. FORWARDER CONFIGURATION.

```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.22000.2538]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Windows\system32>C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\bin\splunk.exe list forward-server
The system cannot find the path specified.

C:\Windows\system32>C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\bin\splunk.exe list forward-server
Splunk username: clifford
Password:
Active forwards:
    127.0.0.1:9997
Configured but inactive forwards:
    None

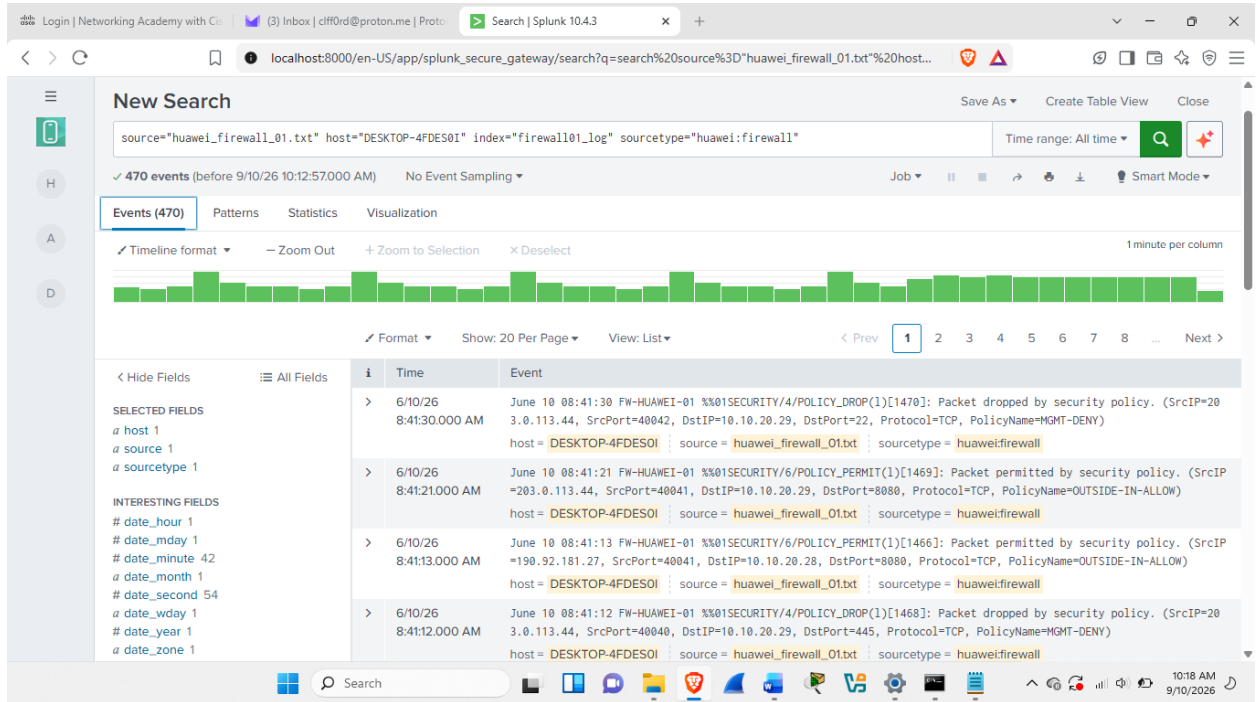
C:\Windows\system32>
```

```
Administrator: Command Prompt
-index "firewall logs"
Added monitor of 'C:\Users\HP\Downloads\huawei_firewall_01.txt'.

C:\Windows\system32>C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\bin\splunk.exe list monitor
Monitored Directories:
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\audit.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\audit_v2.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\btool.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\conf.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\first_install.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\health.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\license_usage.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\mergebuckets.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\mongod.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\mongod_upgrade.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\remote_searches.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\scheduler.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\search_messages.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\searchhistory.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\splunkd-utility.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\splunkd_access.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\splunkd_ui_access.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\wlm_monitor.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk\configuration_change.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\configuration_change.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk\license_usage_summary.log*
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\license_usage_summary.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk\metrics.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\metrics.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk\splunk_instrumentation_cloud.log*
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\splunk_instrumentation_cloud.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\splunk\splunkd.log
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\splunk\splunkd.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\log\watchdog\watchdog.log*
        C:\Program Files\SplunkUniversalForwarder\var\log\watchdog\watchdog.log
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\run\splunk\search_telemetry\*search_telemetry.json
    $SPLUNK_HOME\var\spool\splunk\tracker.log*
Monitored Files:
    $SPLUNK_HOME\etc\splunk.version
    C:\Users\HP\Downloads\huawei_firewall_01.txt

C:\Windows\system32>
```

II. DATA INPUT CONFIGURATION.



New Search

source="huawei_firewall_01.txt" host="DESKTOP-4FDES01" index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall"

Time range: All time

✓ 470 events (before 9/10/26 10:12:57.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events (470) Patterns Statistics Visualization

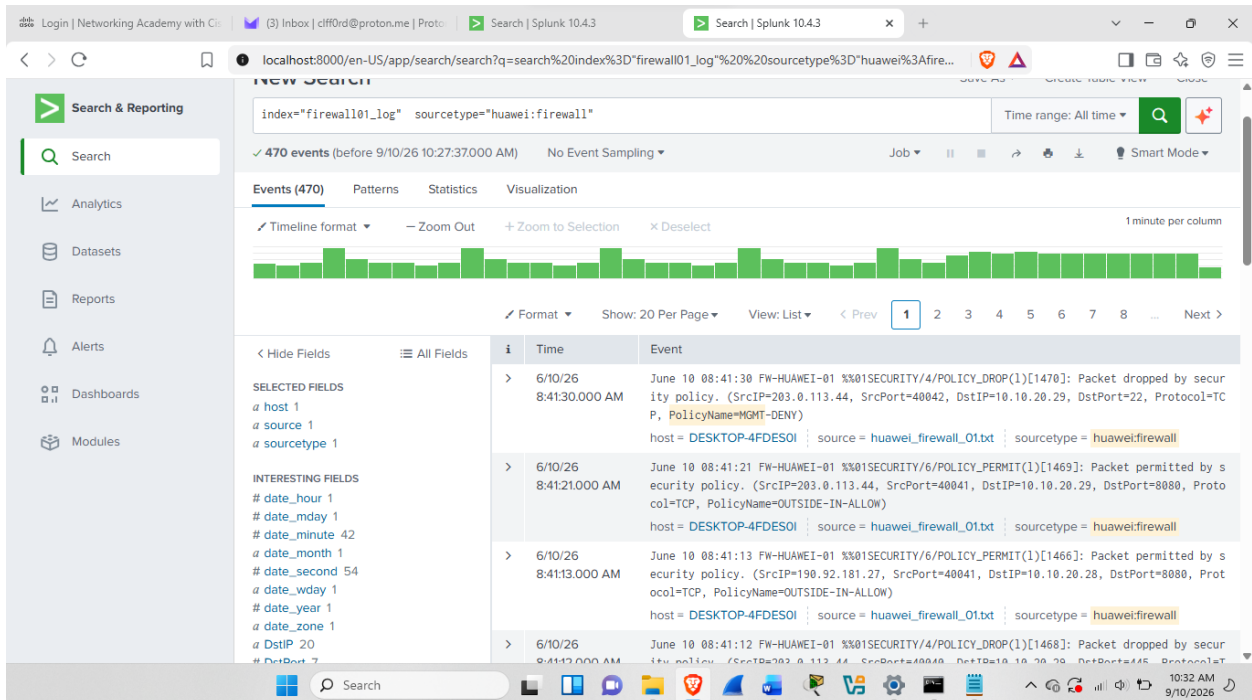
Timeline format Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect

Format Show: 20 Per Page View: List

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 ... Next

Time	Event
6/10/26 8:41:30.000 AM	June 10 08:41:30 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1470]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40042, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=22, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:21.000 AM	June 10 08:41:21 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/6/POLICY_PERMIT(1)[1469]: Packet permitted by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40041, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=8080, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:13.000 AM	June 10 08:41:13 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/6/POLICY_PERMIT(1)[1466]: Packet permitted by security policy. (SrcIP=190.92.181.27, SrcPort=40041, DstIP=10.10.20.28, DstPort=8080, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:12.000 AM	June 10 08:41:12 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1468]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40040, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=445, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall

1. ASSIGNING SOURCE TYPE.



Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards Modules

New Search

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall"

Time range: All time

✓ 470 events (before 9/10/26 10:27:37.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events (470) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Timeline format Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect

Format Show: 20 Per Page View: List

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 ... Next

Time	Event
6/10/26 8:41:30.000 AM	June 10 08:41:30 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1470]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40042, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=22, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:21.000 AM	June 10 08:41:21 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/6/POLICY_PERMIT(1)[1469]: Packet permitted by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40041, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=8080, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:13.000 AM	June 10 08:41:13 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/6/POLICY_PERMIT(1)[1466]: Packet permitted by security policy. (SrcIP=190.92.181.27, SrcPort=40041, DstIP=10.10.20.28, DstPort=8080, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:41:12.000 AM	June 10 08:41:12 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1468]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40040, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=445, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDES01 source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall

2. SEARCHING REPORTING AND DASHBOARD

I performed basic search using SPL, applied filters, used statistical commands (use of charts and bar graphs) and then created and saved a report.

The screenshot shows the Splunk Search & Reporting interface. The search bar contains the query: `index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall" "LOGIN_FAIL"`. The search results show 190 events. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like Search, Analytics, Datasets, Reports, Alerts, Dashboards, and Modules. The main panel displays a timeline chart and a table of events. The table columns are Time and Event. The events listed are login failures for various users and IP addresses.

Time	Event
6/10/26 8:29:43.000 AM	June 10 08:29:43 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1200]: Login failed. (UserName=root, IPAddress=203.0.113.44, VTY=7, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:29:36.000 AM	June 10 08:29:36 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1199]: Login failed. (UserName=admin, IPAddress=203.0.113.44, VTY=7, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:29:29.000 AM	June 10 08:29:29 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1198]: Login failed. (UserName=bac kup, IPAddress=203.0.113.44, VTY=7, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:29:22.000 AM	June 10 08:29:22 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/4/LOGIN_FAIL(1)[1197]: Login failed. (UserName=bac kup, IPAddress=203.0.113.44, VTY=7, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall

The screenshot shows the Splunk Search & Reporting interface. The search bar contains the query: `index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall" "LOGIN_SUCCESS"`. The search results show 10 events. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like Search, Analytics, Datasets, Reports, Alerts, Dashboards, and Modules. The main panel displays a timeline chart and a table of events. The table columns are Time and Event. The events listed are login successes for various users and IP addresses.

Time	Event
6/10/26 8:26:43.000 AM	June 10 08:26:43 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/5/LOGIN_SUCCESS(1)[1180]: User login succeeded. (U serName=admin, IPAddress=157.245.33.71, VTY=3, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:25:58.000 AM	June 10 08:25:58 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/5/LOGIN_SUCCESS(1)[1175]: User login succeeded. (U serName=guest, IPAddress=143.110.221.29, VTY=2, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:20:43.000 AM	June 10 08:20:43 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/5/LOGIN_SUCCESS(1)[1140]: User login succeeded. (U serName=admin, IPAddress=159.65.88.19, VTY=3, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
6/10/26 8:19:58.000 AM	June 10 08:19:58 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SHELL/5/LOGIN_SUCCESS(1)[1135]: User login succeeded. (U serName=operator, IPAddress=138.68.77.42, VTY=2, Protocol=SSH) host = DESKTOP-4FDES0I source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall

Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Modules

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall" "DROP" Time range: All time

91 events (before 9/10/26 10:41:45.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events (91) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Timeline format Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 minute per column

Format Show: 20 Per Page View: List Prev 1 2 3 4 5 Next

Hide Fields	All Fields	i	Time	Event
SELECTED FIELDS a host 1 a source 1 a sourcetype 1	INTERESTING FIELDS # date_hour 1 # date_mday 1 # date_minute 12 # date_month 1 # date_second 43 # date_wday 1 # date_year 1	>	6/10/26 8:41:30.000 AM	June 10 08:41:30 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1470]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40042, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=22, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDESOI source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
		>	6/10/26 8:41:12.000 AM	June 10 08:41:12 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1468]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=203.0.113.44, SrcPort=40040, DstIP=10.10.20.29, DstPort=445, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDESOI source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall
		>	6/10/26 8:41:04.000 AM	June 10 08:41:04 FW-HUAWEI-01 %01SECURITY/4/POLICY_DROP(1)[1465]: Packet dropped by security policy. (SrcIP=190.92.181.27, SrcPort=40040, DstIP=10.10.20.28, DstPort=445, Protocol=TCP, PolicyName=MGMT-DENY) host = DESKTOP-4FDESOI source = huawei_firewall_01.txt sourcetype = huawei:firewall

Splunk Enterprise

Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Modules

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall"
| stats count by PolicyName

Time range: All time

470 events (before 9/10/26 10:45:29.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events Patterns Statistics (2) Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page Format Preview: On

PolicyName	count
MGMT-DENY	91
OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW	69

Search | Splunk 10.4.3

localhost:8000/en-US/app/search/search?q=search%20index%3D"firewall01_log"%20sourcetype%3D"huawei%3Afirewall"...

splunk> Enterprise

Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Modules

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall"
| top PolicyName

Time range: All time

470 events (before 9/10/26 10:50:19.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events Patterns **Statistics (2)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page Format Preview: On

PolicyName	count	percent
MGMT-DENY	91	56.875000
OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW	69	43.125000

10:50 AM 9/10/2026

Search | Splunk 10.4.3

localhost:8000/en-US/app/search/search?q=search%20index%3D"firewall01_log"%20sourcetype%3D"huawei%3Afirewall"...

splunk> Enterprise

Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Modules

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall"
| chart count by host

Time range: All time

470 events (before 9/10/26 10:52:09.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Events Patterns **Statistics (1)** Visualization

Show: 20 Per Page Format Preview: On

host	count
DESKTOP-4FDES01	470

10:52 AM 9/10/2026

Search | Splunk 10.4.3

localhost:8000/en-US/app/search/search?q=search%20index%3D%22firewall01_log%22sourcetype%3D%22huawei%3Afirewall%22%20chart%20count%20by%20PolicyName

splunk> Enterprise

Search & Reporting

Search

Analytics

Datasets

Reports

Alerts

Dashboards

Modules

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

index="firewall01_log" sourcetype="huawei:firewall" | chart count by PolicyName

Time range: All time

470 events (before 9/10/26 10:58:32.000 AM) No Event Sampling

Job Visualization

Events Patterns Statistics (2)

Show: 20 Per Page Format Preview: On

PolicyName	count
MGMT-DENY	91
OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW	69

Search

10:58 AM 9/10/2026

TASK 3. CONFIGURATION & SECURITY BEST PRACTICES

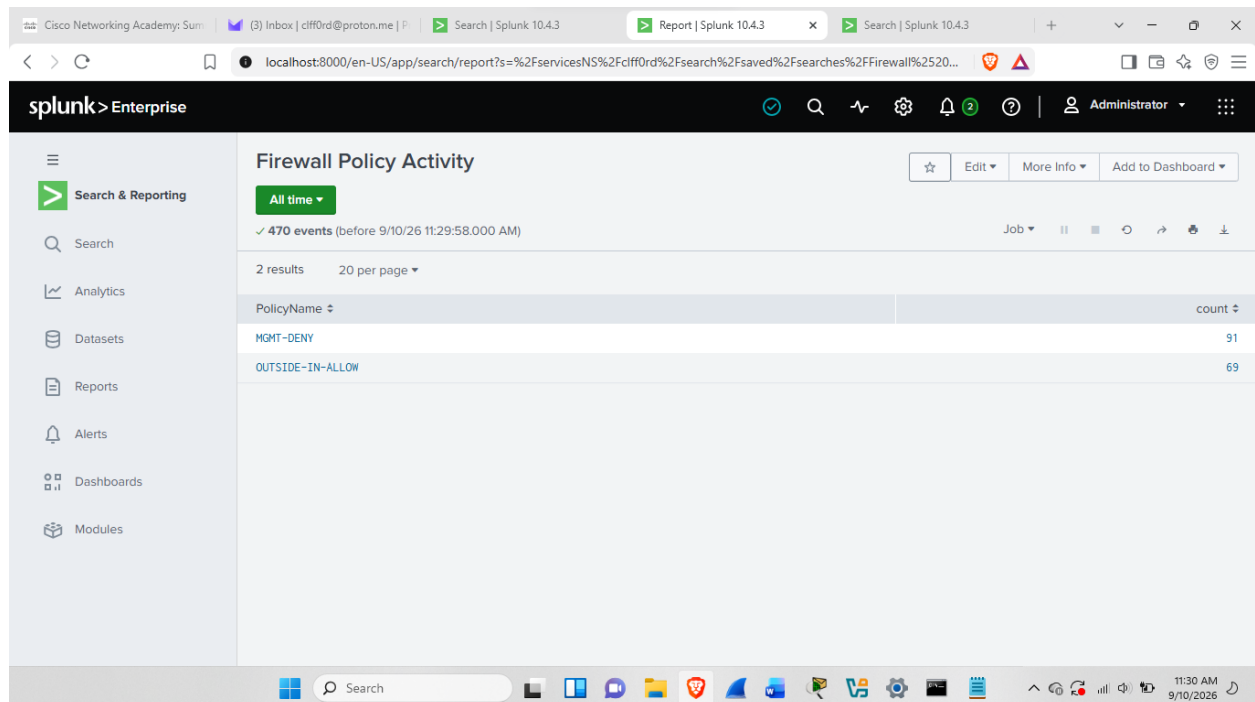
🚦 New Users, Roles, RBAC and Data index Retention/index)

On my project, I used Splunk to centralize and analyze firewall traffic logs to improve network visibility. I monitored incoming log data to watch for security anomalies. Specifically, I used Splunk's Search Processing Language (SPL) to build queries that tracked **denied traffic**. For example, I monitored for spikes in blocked connections from foreign IP addresses, which usually indicate a reconnaissance or brute-force attempt. By correlating firewall drop events with our internal asset list, I could quickly see if a malicious actor was actively scanning our critical infrastructure. This allowed us to identify potential threats in real-time rather than manually digging through flat text files on individual network devices.

EXAMPLE

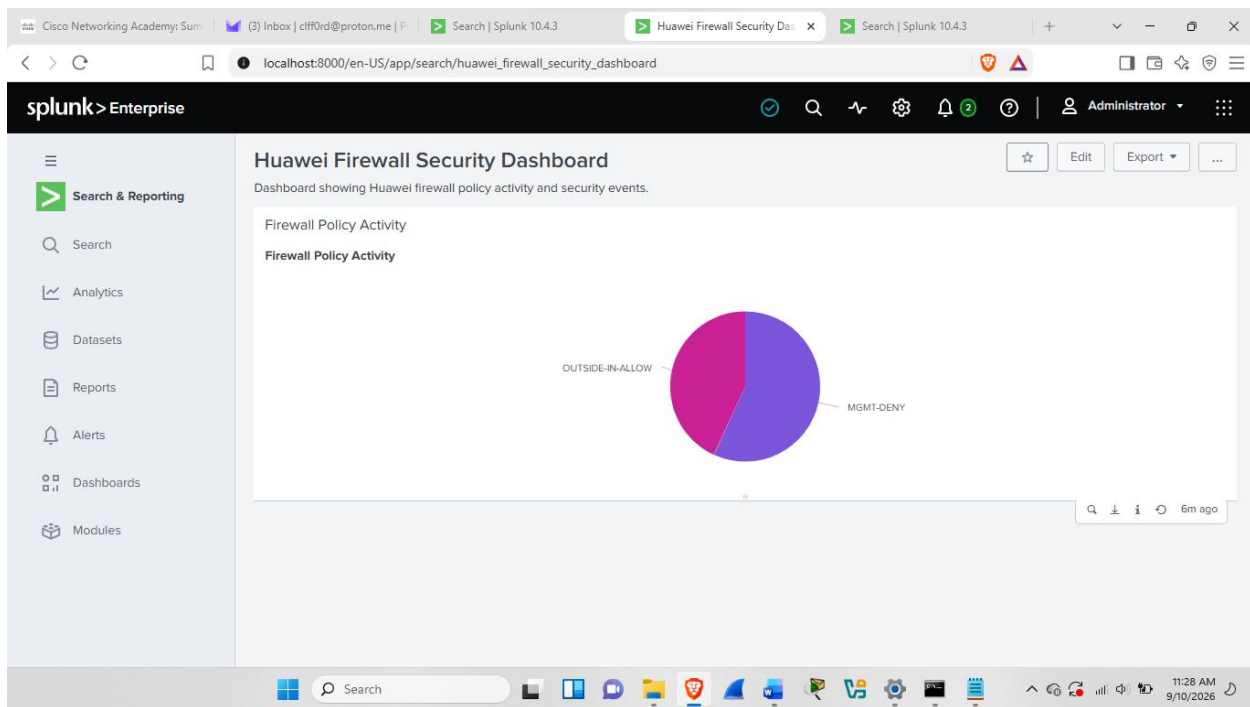
```
index=netops sourcetype=cisco: asa action=blocked
-stats count by src_ip
-sort - count
```

NOTE_- Explanation: This tells Splunk to look at network logs from a Cisco firewall, find all blocked connections, count how many times each external IP address got blocked, and sort them from highest to lowest so you can see the top offender immediately.



The screenshot shows the Splunk Enterprise web interface. The top navigation bar includes the Splunk logo, 'Enterprise' label, and various icons for search, settings, alerts, and user management. The left sidebar contains a menu with options like Search & Reporting, Search, Analytics, Datasets, Reports, Alerts, Dashboards, and Modules. The main content area displays a report titled 'Firewall Policy Activity'. Above the report, there are buttons for 'All time', 'Edit', 'More Info', and 'Add to Dashboard'. Below the title, it indicates '✓ 470 events (before 9/10/26 11:29:58.000 AM)'. The report shows '2 results' and '20 per page'. The results are presented in a table with two columns: 'PolicyName' and 'count'. The table contains two rows: 'MGMT-DENY' with a count of 91, and 'OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW' with a count of 69. The bottom of the screenshot shows the Windows taskbar with the search bar and various application icons.

PolicyName	count
MGMT-DENY	91
OUTSIDE-IN-ALLOW	69



Cisco Networking Academy: Summer | (3) Inbox | cliff0rd@proton.me | Proton | Search | Splunk 10.4.3

Users

localhost:8000/en-US/manager/search/authentication/users

splunk> Enterprise

Users

New User

Search via role, application, or capability name

Showing 1-2 of 2 Users

Name ↕	Authentication system ↕	Full name ↕	Email address ↕	Time zone ↕	Default app ↕	Default app inherited from ↕	Roles ↕	Last login ↕	Status ↕	
cliff0rd	Splunk	Administrator	changeme@example.com		launcher	system	admin	9/10/2026, 8:02:20 AM	Active	
security_analyst	Splunk				launcher	system	user user-security_analyst		Active	

Showing 1-2 of 2 Users

Search

11:45 AM 9/10/2026

Cisco Networking Academy: Summer | (3) Inbox | cliff0rd@proton.me | Proton | Search | Splunk 10.4.3

Roles

localhost:8000/en-US/manager/search/authorization/roles

splunk> Enterprise

Roles

New Role

You can search keywords like role name, application name and capability name...

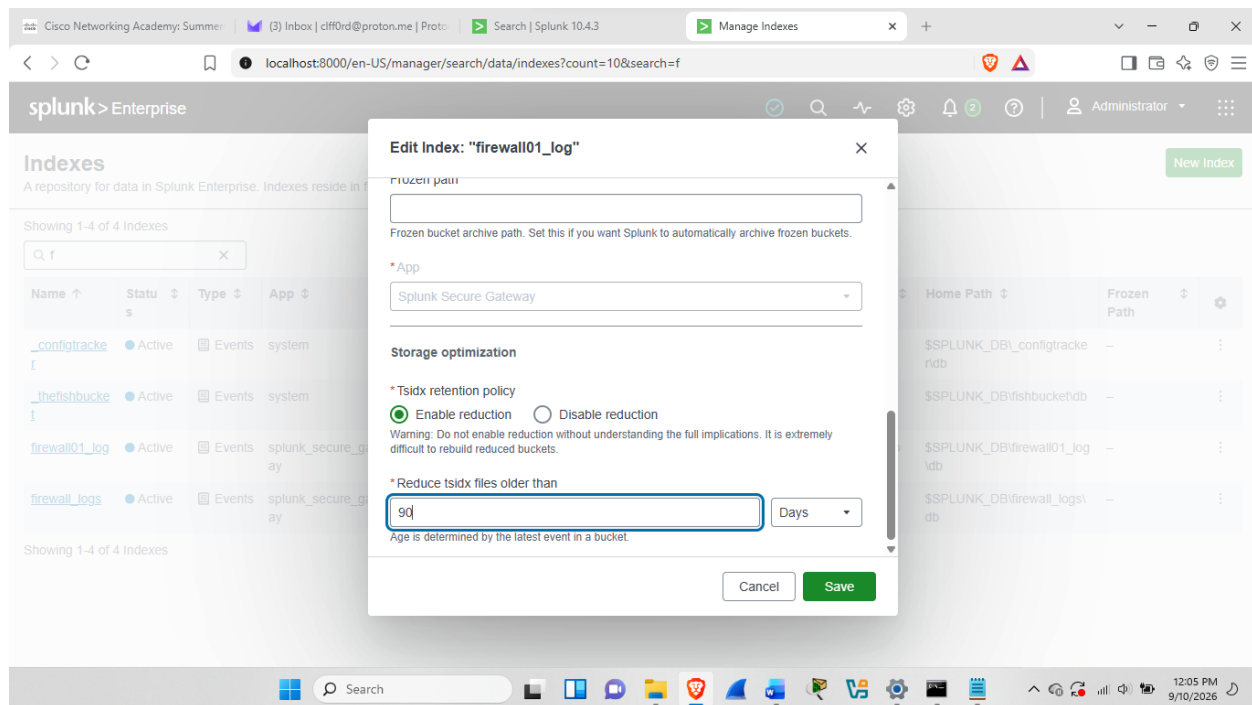
Showing 1-7 of 7 Roles

Name ↑	Native Capabilities	Inherited Capabilities	Default App ↕	
admin	147	50		
can_delete	6	0		
power	18	32		
security_analyst	1	32		
splunk-system-role	0	197		
user	32	0		
user-security_analyst	0	0		

Showing 1-7 of 7 Roles

Search

11:53 AM 9/10/2026



When implementing Splunk for security operations, my approach centers on data integrity, standardization, and the principle of least privilege. For example, during a security monitoring project, I ensured that data collected from network firewalls via forwarders was explicitly mapped to the **Splunk Common Information Model (CIM)**. This normalization is critical because it ensures that whether we are searching Cisco ASA or host firewall logs, our correlation rules and dashboards parse fields like `src_ip` and `action=blocked` universally.

Furthermore, from an architectural standpoint, I advocate for strict index segregation—separating raw network data from sensitive authentication logs so that we can apply precise Role-Based Access Control (RBAC). Finally, I focus heavily on search optimization: making sure all alerting queries are highly scoped to specific indexes and source types rather than using open wildcards, which protects system resources and reduces our alert triage time.

THE END!